



security, but are again evolving. That's a great opportunity for India. Today, there's no reason why India cannot become a food exporter at scale. Look at South America, especially the field crop countries. These are completely export driven and very open to technology. It helps in driving their agricultural systems.

The US is unpredictable at the moment. Agricultural exports are becoming more difficult from the US. Then you have Europe, where they have shut down technology, constrained farming and still have a highly subsidised agricultural model. Growers are being asked to be less productive... Europe could become a food importer. Each sphere is evolving very differently.

Q: Drawing up a business plan at a time like this is a difficult proposition...

A: At Syngenta, we're spending almost \$1.5 billion on R&D across the world, that is, in over 100 countries and more than 100 crops. It takes about 13 years on average to bring a new product to the market. That means we have to think at least 15-20 years ahead. It's not easy, but that is the nature of our business. We're present only in agriculture and are committed to finding our way around it.

A short-term approach will not work. At the end of the day, this is about supporting food production in a manner that is environmentally friendly and that has a different level of responsibility. Like I said, this is

the only business that we are in and, therefore, need to take a long-term view.

Q: Will we see instances of something that has worked well in Brazil moving to India?

A: There are many opportunities. It could be in insecticides, for example. We have Tymirium (a technology that provides long-lasting protection against the highly destructive plant-parasitic nematodes and soil-borne diseases) or Adepidyn (a technology for fungicide to improve plant health) that have been co-developed by markets that have similar challenges. Getting back to the example of Brazil, it's critical that we have the input coming in from India, plus the work that we do locally to develop these products.

We will continue to invest in India and, in time, given what is taking in other global markets, the profile of India, not only as a market, but as a contributor to our research and development pipeline is only set to increase in the future.

Q: A lot of Syngenta's growth globally has been through buyouts. What is the inorganic strategy for India?

A: India is a fragmented market, and I believe that it will take time to consolidate and that's because of the nature of the products. They are so much more specific and specialised and, by design, there will be

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more companies and more products. It will be fragmented for a long time. Our strategy is to pick the options carefully. That said, we are very much in the growth mode. It's not just about the money. There must be a right fit, the right market need and a good understanding of the customer needs. **BT**

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